

When the economy was booming, Tom made lots of money and was able to accumulate a small fortune. Unfortunately, the boom days didn't last forever, and Tom hadn't sold a property in over a year. At first they weren't worried since their nest egg was quite sizable and they were certain that he would sell a property before long. Even though their nest egg was large, so too were their monthly expenses. Before long their nest egg was down to \$7,500. Considering the fact that their monthly personal and business expenses totaled \$10,000, this was not a lot of money!

Anita decided she had to do something proactive, so she made an appointment for them to see a credit counselor. Their counselor started with recommendations of which expenses could be eliminated or reduced. Her suggestion was to close down Anita's art gallery, which was losing money each month. That would free up Anita to take care of the children and therefore, they wouldn't need the live-in nanny. This would result in savings in food costs, salary, and car payment and insurance for the nanny's leased car.

Well Anita wouldn't hear of it! She absolutely refused to change diapers and didn't know how to cook. Besides, she loved her art gallery regardless of the fact that it was losing money. Everyone in the neighborhood had a live-in nanny, even if the wife stayed home full-time. What would the neighbors whisper if they no longer had a nanny? They would be humiliated. No, these suggestions were totally unacceptable.

Many people, when asked to give things up, tend to resist and come up with all kinds of reasons that start with "yes, but":

- I'd give up my mobile phone, but what if my car breaks down?
- I'd give up my health club membership, but then I'll get fat.

